

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Wednesday, July 22, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (4 stories)

■ **Chicken thighs just got way more expensive—here's why**

***The Angle:** Grocery prices keep hitting us in unexpected places. Chicken thighs spiked 8.2% in a single month—bigger jump than beef or coffee—and it's a signal that food inflation is spreading beyond the usual suspects.*

- Chicken thigh prices jumped 8.2 per cent from May to June alone
- That surge outpaced increases for **beef and coffee**, typically the headline inflation drivers
- Data comes from official **inflation numbers** tracking month-to-month grocery shifts

The Wallet Check

- Are you seeing this at your grocery store—paying more for chicken thighs than you expected?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/chicken-thigh-prices-canada-9.7277782?cmp=rss>

■ **Ontario First Nations demand inquiry into wildfire response failures**

***The Angle:** Indigenous communities in northwestern Ontario say they were left to fend for themselves during major wildfires, with evacuation support and communication from the provincial government falling dangerously short. Now tribal leaders are pushing back hard—and it's raising questions about disaster preparedness across Canada.*

- Gull Bay First Nation Chief Wilfred King says **the lack of communication and evacuation support should horrify all Canadians**
- More than **a dozen evacuations** were triggered by wildfires in northwestern Ontario
- First Nation chiefs are calling for a **public inquiry** into Ontario's wildfire response
- Communities say they were **left on their own** to manage the crisis

The Accountability Question

- When disaster strikes remote communities, who's actually responsible—and what does 'evacuation support' really mean if nobody shows up?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/thunder-bay/wildfire-response-public-inquiry-9.7278584?cmp=rss>

■ **Wildfire smoke crosses borders, turns US skies orange**

***The Angle:** Ontario wildfires are sending smoke hundreds of miles south into major U.S. cities, triggering air quality crises and reigniting the cross-border climate debate. This summer's smoke patterns are normal—but the wildfires themselves are getting worse, and both countries are caught in the same hazy problem.*

- Smoke from **Ontario wildfires** is traveling as far as **New York City**, turning distant city skies **orange**
- Air quality warnings are being triggered in U.S. cities far from the fire source
- Experts say **the smoke patterns aren't unusual**, but **wildfires are intensifying** on both sides of the border
- The smoke surge is fueling **heated political rhetoric** between the U.S. and Canada

The Shared Crisis

- Should wildfire-affected countries be splitting climate investment and disaster prep costs—or is this just nature doing what nature does?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/wildfire-smoke-canada-us-faq-9.7271878?cmp=rss>

■ Supreme Court gerrymandering ruling forces Louisiana congressman out

The Angle: A Black congressman is stepping back after the Supreme Court struck down his district as an unconstitutional racial gerrymander—raising hard questions about how you draw fair maps when courts keep changing the rules.

- Rep. Cleo Fields announced he won't seek re-election to a second House term
- The Supreme Court ruled this year that his majority-Black Louisiana district was an 'unconstitutional gerrymander'
- Fields was first elected in 2022 to represent the redrawn district

The Thorny Question

- How do you draw a district map that's fair to everyone when courts keep changing what 'fair' even means?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/22/us-news/louisiana-rep-cleo-fields-wont-seek-re-election/>

TRENDING TODAY

■ Influencers pushing dangerous 'tanmaxxing' trend to teens—no sunscreen required

The Angle: TikTok creators are promoting unsafe tanning practices to young audiences, mixing body oil with high-UV exposure and skipping SPF altogether. It's the latest example of wellness misinformation going viral and putting kids at real health risk.

- The trend is called 'tanmaxxing' and involves using body oil and high-UV conditions without sunscreen
- TikTok influencers are actively spreading misinformation about sun safety and tanning 'benefits' to teen audiences
- Users are overselling the supposed benefits of tanning while downplaying skin cancer and premature aging risks

The Safety Check

- How many of you—or your kids—follow tanning influencers online without realizing they're literally giving you dangerous advice?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- Step 1: Name the trend - Quick context-setting -> Hosts explain what 'tanmaxxing' is and where it's spreading (TikTok, Instagram)

- Step 2: Bust the myths - Host riff or bring in caller -> Go through the false claims influencers are making—'sun exposure is healthy,' 'you don't need SPF,' etc.—and hit them with actual dermatology facts

- Step 3: The call-in - Open phone lines -> Ask listeners: Have you seen this trend? Are your teens following these accounts? What misinformation are they buying into?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/22/health/tanmaxxers-are-teaching-teens-how-to-maximize-color-and-no-spf/>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ Manitoba finally pays retiree for surgery they twice denied

The Angle: A 69-year-old waited nearly two years fighting his province for coverage of spine surgery he had to pay for himself—and just won. It's a frustrating look at how healthcare bureaucracy can force patients to choose

- **Tom Molinski**, 69, received a cheque for nearly **\$24,000** from **Manitoba Health**
- The province **twice refused** to reimburse him for out-of-country spine surgery
- He waited **nearly two years** before the province finally reversed course

● Have you ever had to fight a bureaucracy for coverage they should've covered in the first place—and how long did it take to win?

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/province-partially-repays-patient-spinal-surgery-germany-9.7275532?cmp=rss>

■ Mental health support gaps in Caribbean-Canadian communities

- Caribbean-Canadian communities experience **distinct mental health barriers** including cultural stigma around mental illness and limited access to culturally competent care
- Language, immigration-related stress, and **underrepresentation in mental health services** create significant gaps in support
- Community-led initiatives and culturally tailored mental health programs are emerging as effective models for reaching these populations

- How many listeners know someone in their Caribbean-Canadian circle who's struggling but won't seek help because of the stigma—and what would actually make them comfortable reaching out?

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMixwFBVV95cUxQR0MzTGw5NTIMMGJpeFMwOVIFQW4wRWd0RDE5bFUxZDQ1TERXUVo3bzZCVnFudWUwQ09TVjV6Q0Z3Yzphd0lzMWRpZ054dEU2RFEyY29nS3dyYVN5NGZrU1NMMWRuWENhbXFDjdjPZWdKSv8tNElaRmpuTHZtWkMzNGVxc005aWFvQk1hT2tENWpDbUp3WkwwdjJSc0t0Q2FIM1IPclZmNzZ4ekR5dThia29zSENpVENkRWVyNHFmd1JRQnh0OFpJ?oc=5>

The Angle: A cyclospora outbreak tied to lettuce has people nervous about their produce. We're breaking down which greens are risky and which are fine—plus what you actually need to know to eat safely.

- **Cyclospora** is a parasite causing "**explosive**" **diarrhea** linked to contaminated lettuce
- Federal health officials are actively investigating the source of the outbreak
- The infection spreads through contaminated produce, not person-to-person contact

● Have you already thrown out your lettuce, or are you waiting to hear which specific brands or types are actually unsafe?

- **Step 1: The Lettuce Lineup** - 30 seconds -> Host A holds up different lettuce types (or describes them), Host B calls out which ones are on the watch list vs. safe to eat based on the outbreak details.

- **Step 2: The Storage Sniff Test** - 20 seconds -> Host B shares the actual signs your lettuce might be compromised—color, smell, texture—so listeners know what to look for beyond just brand names.

- **Step 3: Caller Callback** - Open lines -> Hit the phones: 'Did you already toss lettuce over this? Or are you still eating it anyway?' Get real listener behavior on tape.

URL: <https://thehill.com/policy/healthcare/5978848-how-to-tell-if-your-lettuce-is-safe-to-eat-during-cyclospora-outbreak/>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ **Doctor's Wild Cure: This Guy Bikes Away His Pain**

***The Angle:** A man diagnosed with a rare, debilitating nerve condition found relief not through medication, but by riding an e-bike across the country—a story about unconventional healing that challenges how we think about chronic pain treatment.*

- **Gregory Maassen** suffered from a rare form of neuropathy—a burning sensation that spread from his arm to his entire body **from his ears to his feet**
- The condition left him nearly bedridden before his doctor suggested an unlikely prescription: riding an **e-bike across the country**
- The unconventional treatment worked, offering Maassen significant relief from his unbearable pain

The Healing Question

- Have you ever found relief from something the doctors didn't prescribe—something totally unexpected?

The Washington Post (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.washingtonpost.com/lifestyle/2026/07/21/his-doctors-prescription-his-unbearable-pain-seemed-absurd-it-worked/>

Backup options:

■ **Gordie Howe Bridge opens, but U.S. stays home due to trade tensions**

***The Angle:** A major cross-border infrastructure project finally opens after years of delays and construction—but political friction means there's no joint celebration. It's a small sign of how trade tensions are cooling even routine diplomacy.*

- The **Gordie Howe International Bridge** is opening this week
- Canada will celebrate the opening, but **no cross-border ceremony** with the U.S. is planned
- The snub comes amid **U.S. trade threats** against Canada
- Federal **Infrastructure Minister** confirmed the solo Canadian celebration

The Awkward Symbol

- When you can't even celebrate a bridge together, how bad is the trade war really getting?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 49/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality - 25 penalty (used within the last 30 days)) -> BACKUP

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/windsor/windsor-gordie-howe-bridge-ribbon-cutting-9.7278519?cmp=rss>

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ **Trump green-lights Saudi uranium deal—here's what that means**

***The Angle:** The Trump administration just approved a nuclear agreement that could give Saudi Arabia the ability to enrich its own uranium. This is a major geopolitical move with huge implications for Middle East stability and nuclear proliferation—and it's already sparking serious debate about whether the U.S. just handed a regional power a dangerous new tool.*

- **Donald Trump** has approved an agreement with **Saudi Arabia** involving uranium enrichment capability

- The deal covers **civilian nuclear program** development, according to **two people familiar with the matter**
- The agreement could allow the kingdom to enrich uranium domestically rather than relying on outside sources

The Watercooler Flashpoint

- Is this smart diplomacy and economic partnership, or did the U.S. just create a nuclear headache in the Middle East?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/trump-saudi-arabia-nuclear-agreement-9.7278994?cmp=rss>

■ ■ Cosby Show actor Malcolm-Jamal Warner's widow sues his mother for \$1.2M US

The Angle: *Cosby Show actor Malcolm-Jamal Warner's widow sues his mother for \$1.2M US*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/malcolm-jamal-warner-widow-sues-mother-in-law-9.7278896?cmp=rss>

■ B.C. Mounties issue Amber Alert for missing 4-year-old

The Angle: *An active Amber Alert is out right now for a young child missing in British Columbia—this is the kind of breaking, real-time story that reaches listeners across the country because family safety matters to everyone, and tips from the public often crack these cases fast.*

- **Atlas Andrews**, age 4, was last seen on **Ridge Boulevard West in Kelowna, B.C.** at **11:20 a.m. Tuesday**
- **West Kelowna RCMP** issued the Amber Alert
- This is an active missing-child case—time is critical in these situations

The Alert Spread

- If you're in B.C. or have connections there, stay alert—listeners who spot anything should dial local RCMP immediately, and everyone else can help by sharing this alert in their networks.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/amber-alert-british-columbia-9.7278998?cmp=rss>

■ Meeting at a 'turbulent' time: Inuit Circumpolar Council gathers for general assembly in Iqaluit

The Angle: *Meeting at a 'turbulent' time: Inuit Circumpolar Council gathers for general assembly in Iqaluit*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/north/inuit-circumpolar-council-general-assembly-iquait-9.7276480?cmp=rss>

■ Jewish rights group skewers sleazeball Mamdani for peddling Hamas propaganda in televised 'political spectacle'

The Angle: *Jewish rights group skewers sleazeball Mamdani for peddling Hamas propaganda in televised 'political spectacle'*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/07/22/us-news/jewish-rights-group-skewers-zohran-mamdani-for-peddling-hamas-propaganda-in-televised-political-spectacle/>

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ An Australian woman gives birth to rare identical quadruplet girls <https://t.co/rccj9G27Mv>

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Rare identical quadruplets is a genuine medical anomaly with strong human interest appeal and clear shareability that low engagement may not yet reflect.

The Angle: *An Australian woman gives birth to rare identical quadruplet girls* <https://t.co/rccj9G27Mv>

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2079891853382430861>

■ **It's almost time. ■■ Gizmodo is on the ground in London for Samsung's #GalaxyUnpacked! We're expecting Samsung to unveil more durable foldab**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Samsung Galaxy Unpacked is a live event with real-time product reveal momentum—engagement typically spikes post-announcement when specs drop.

The Angle: *It's almost time. ■■ Gizmodo is on the ground in London for Samsung's #GalaxyUnpacked! We're expecting Samsung to unveil more durable foldab*

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2079905929823154521>

■■ **Luke's 'Empire Strikes Back' Lightsaber (With Severed Hand) Sells for \$3.75 Million**
<https://t.co/PMXjaZzhQT>

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): \$3.75M Star Wars prop sale hits the intersection of nostalgia, high-value collectibles, and pop culture fandom—strong viral potential despite low current traction.

The Angle: *Luke's 'Empire Strikes Back' Lightsaber (With Severed Hand) Sells for \$3.75 Million*
<https://t.co/PMXjaZzhQT>

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2079884435856429380>

■ **Elon Musk has pledged to create a "historically accurate" version of #TheOdyssey using his AI chatbot Grok "before this year ends." https://**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Elon Musk + AI generating classic literature is a novel angle on AI capability/ambition that appeals to both tech and humanities audiences still forming opinions.

The Angle: *Elon Musk has pledged to create a "historically accurate" version of #TheOdyssey using his AI chatbot Grok "before this year ends." https://*

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/Variety/status/2079871194350617004>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 6 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)

- "Lake Tahoe home invaded by creepy squatter as bizarre details emerge" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-11)

- "Liberty's Betnijah Laney-Hamilton ejected for throwing teammate's shoe at opponent in bizarre scene" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-12)

- "Mike Tyson makes bizarre Shohei Ohtani remark at ESPYs" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)

- "Firefighters rescue man from s-tty situation after he gets trapped in porta-potty in Kansas City" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)

- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 31 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After 'Bottle Rocket' Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)

- "'Rent' West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)

- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)

- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)

- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)

- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro 'Miró' Sneakers: Here's Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)

- "Thousands of 'Pokémon Go' Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)

- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)

- "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to 'Fruit Gathering,' 'The Guest,' 'Lover, Not a Fighter' and 'Incinerator'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)

- "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: "Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)

- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)

- "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in 'RHOA' Cynthia Bailey's photo" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-12)

- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium <https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c>" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-12)

- "Who Can Begrudge Gen Z Nostalgia For an Era Before They Were Born?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-12)

- "Emerging Directors Need to Be 'Brave,' 'Curious,' 'Pushy' and 'Fearless,' Say Industry Leaders Behind Future Frames Program" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)

- "'Cats: The Jellicle Ball' Ending Broadway Run in August" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-13)

- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars' favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-list-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "Google Images Is Trying to Be... Pinterest?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale has deep discounts on Free People — including a Taylor Swift-worn skirt" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "Factories Now Ready for iPhone 20's Glass Redesign, Leaker Claims - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-15)

- "'Goodbye, Lara' Is Easily the Most Enchanting Fairy Tale Reimagining You'll Watch This Year" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-15)

- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)

- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: 'Your love will forever be woven into who we are'" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)

- "'Scrubs' Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)

- "The Beauty Finds I'm Buying During Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)

- "'La La Land' 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling's Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)

- "'Harry Potter' Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature 'Sorcerer's Stone' 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)

- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)

Newly banked this run:

- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident"

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "'Harry Potter' Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature 'Sorcerer's Stone' 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series"

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)

- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)

- @NYPost (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)

- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)

- @CTVNews (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)

- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)

- 23 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-22 09:07 AM